Inlwood F.H.

No. 33

United States Consulate
Amoy June 10th 1874

Mr. J. J Henderson Consul

To the Dept. of State

Subject
Japanese Invasion of Formosa:
Complicity of Americans.
Contents
Extract of despatch from Chinese
Board of Trade Foochow.
Consuls Reply to Same.

No: 33.

United States Consulate
Amoy June 10th. 1874.

The Hon J. C. B. Davis
Assistant Sec: of State
Washington. D.C.

Sir.

I have the honor to enclose an extract from a despatch which I. a day or two since received from the Chinese Board of Trade at Foochow complaining of the Conduct of Mr Le Gendre, and Lieut. Commander Cassel U. S. N with reference to the Japanese expedition in Formosa, also a Copy of my reply to same.

Enclosure No. 1

Enclosure No. 2

The Vice Roy at Foochow has recently ordered the Tontai at this port to employ the Telegraph Cables in the transmission of news to Peking.

I am informed that President of the Board of Trade at Foochow has been appointed Imperial Commissioner to go to Formosa and settle matters with the Japanese.

I think it improbable that they will come to an understanding satisfactory to both Parties, and it appears equally improbable that actual hostilities will commence between China & Japan for some time to come.

I have the honor to be
Sir.
Your obedient Servant
J. J. Anderson
U. S. Consul.

Inclosures
1. Extract from letter from Board of Trade at Foochow.
2. Reply to same.

Sub Inclosure
1. Copy of original extract from Board of Trade Foochow

貴國立約通商以來
大伯理璽天德修好和睦最相友善從前中國使臣奉使
貴國極荷優禮是以中國官民尤為欣悅
貴領事與中國交涉公事俱和衷共濟恪守條約秉
公辦理中國商民頌聲滿道嗽道亦深悅佩茲核
台灣道及輪船管帶官函達前因其李讓禮投入日
本主謀統帶兵船及
貴國人受日本僱用管駕兵船諸節似非
貴國官民所應有此是否屬寔亟應請為查辦又經
由局照會
貴國戴領事查照來文事理查辦各在案唯
貴領事係駐在廈門一切情形自必深悉相應一併
備文照會
貴領事煩為查照辦理見覆是荷須至照會
右照會
大合衆國欽命駐劄廈門管理通商事務領事官恒
大清同治拾叁年肆月
十七
日照會

貴國公使鐵　照會

總理衙門称本國駐廈李領事現回本國本大臣現派本國人施姓名智文前往廈門作為副領事官等因在案是李領事于十一年已奉調回國何以近日又有投入日本在內主謀並統領日本兵船往台灣報復生番之說茲核台灣通與楊武營駕官函開前因與各處新聞紙所載如出一口是此事不為無因查此次日本舉兵報復生番並不商准

總理衙門又不候

督憲照覆徑往聊墝札營殊于萬國公法違背是以俄英法各國公使均有行知各口領事官不准本國商人貨與日本船隻裝載軍火兵丁之諭足徵

各公使篤敦友誼和好寔意中國官民無不同深欣悅窈思

貴國立約通商以來

大伯理璽天德修好和睦最相友善從前中國使臣奉使

貴國極荷優禮是以中國官民尤為欣悅

貴領事與中國交涉公事俱和衷共濟恪守條約秉

大清欽命三品銜督辦通商事務署理福建陸 為

照會事案奉

督憲李牌開本年三月二十三日 云云至各等因隨經由局照會駐省

貴國戴領事查照旋于三月二十八日接准

台灣夏道函称日本國兵船到台報復生番傳聞有

貴國前駐廈門領事李讓禮即李仙德更名李贊

達在內主謀又日本兵船有

貴國人四名云云又四月初九日接 查洋商之楊

武輪船言帶官函報云所有赴台日本兵

船係前充廈門領事李讓禮為之總統又

一名克四林耳副之均係

貴國人為船主此次舉動各國均不以為然

英 法 兩國公使由電報通知上海領事禁止伊國船

不准賫貨日本裝俑兵丁軍火前有賃

英國商船裝運軍火赴台者運抵長崎經英

領事飭將該船所載軍火概卸上岸等云查同治十

一年十二月二十四日准

貴國公使鏤 照會

照會

Incl. Copy of enclosure No. 1

Enclosure No. 1

The above has all been communicated to Mr. Deland Am. Consul at Tamsui for his information.

Subsequently we on the 3rd Month 28th day (May 13) received a communication from the Formosa Taotai stating that Jap. Men of war had arrived at Formosa to punish the Savages. That it was reported that the former U.S. Consul at Amoy Le Gendre, otherwise called Li-Sian-Tek, otherwise changed to Li Kan Jat, who had got up the expedition, was connected with it, and further that there were 4 Americans on board the Japanese Vessels.

On 4th Month 9th day (May 24th) we received a letter from the Captain of the Man of War "Wang boo" saying that Japanese Vessels had arrived at Formosa with the former Amoy Consul Le Gendre as Commander in Chief, also one Cassel as 2nd in Command with Americans as Commanders of the Vessels.

This affair is regarded as wrong by men of all Nations. The English & French Ministers have telegraphed to their Consuls at Shanghai to forbid their Vessels being Chartered to the Japanese to Carry Soldiers or Munitions of war. An English Vessel had been previously

chartered to Cary Munitions of war to For=
mosa, but on her Arival at Nagasaki the =
English Consul then ordered all the warlike
goods to be landed. 11th Year
12th Month 21 day (Jan'y 22nd 1873) the Foreign
Office (at Peking) received a Communication
from his Excellency Minister Low saying that
the Amoy Consul having returned home, he
(Mr Low) had appointed an American Mr.
Stevens as Vice Consul in Charge &c &c which
is on file. Now, he Legendre being recalled
home, why is he, as it is said, now for London
Connection with the Japanese, instigating and
taking Charge of this affair as Commander
of the Japanese War Vessels, going to Formosa
to punnish the Savages? The accounts
of the Formosa Towtai and the Captain
of the "Yang-boo" fully agree with all the
Newspaper Reports. So that there must be
truth in it.

On this occasion the Japanese
sent Soldiers to punish the Savages without
Communicating with the Foreign Office,
and without awaiting a Reply from the
Viceroy. But sent them Straight to Liang
Kiang to form a Camp. Surely this is a vio
lation of the Law of Nations, Therefore the
English Russian & French Ministers instruct
ed their respective Consuls not to allow
their Merchants to Charter Vessels to the =
Japanese to Cary Soldiers or Munitions of
war, thus showing that they wished to Cul=
tivate Friendly Relations to the Satisfaction
of the Rulers & People of China.

Again, we Consider that from the time
of Making the Commercial treaty with the
U.S. the President has uniformly acted
in accordance with the interests of Peace
and in the most Friendly Manner.

And when the Imperial Embassy went
to the U. States they were received in a Manner
most grateful to their Feelings, as well as to
the Rulers & People of China. The dealings
of your honorable Self with the Chinese =
Authorities have been of the most Amicable
nature, and every thing has been adjusted acc=
ording to treaty Stipulations, so that the Streets
are full of the praises of Chinese Merchants
and People, and I myself am profoundly
pleased & grateful.

Now, I have investigated the Statement
of the Formosa Towtai & the Captain of the
"Yang-boo", that Le Gendre has Connected him=
self with the Japanese in planning Making
entire Charge of all the troops & Ships & that
besides, nine other Americans have been en=
gaged to take Charge of the War Vessels.
These things ought not to be permitted
by your Rulers & People, and as to the truth
or falsity of these Statements, I ask you
to make a Speedy investigation and take
Necessary Action.

The Board of Trade has
already asked the U. S. Consul at Foochow
(Mr Delano) to investigate & take action
in the Matter all which is on file.

Your Honorable Self as Consul for
Amoy Must know about this whole affair

and we now send this despatch to request you to take the trouble of investigating & managing this affair, and will be thankfull to receive your Answer.

Sick. Superintendent of Salt
Member of the Board
of Trade at Foochow.

To Mr. Henderson
United States Consul
- at Amoy -

Enclosure No. 2

United States Consulate
Amoy. the dependencies thereof.
June 9th 1874

To the Honorable Board of Trade
Foochow

Gentlemen,

I have had the honor to receive your Communication of the 6th inst. referring to the part which Mess.rs Le Gendre, Cassel, and other American Citizens are said to be taking in the Japanese Expedition to Formosa.

Some days before I received your despatch I referred the Case by telegraph to the U. S. Chargé d'Affairs at Peking for instructions, but as I am informed that the Telegraph Cable extends no further than Shanghai, I fear it will require many days to receive a reply.

More recently I requested the United States Naval Forces on the Asiatic Station to Assist in preventing Citizens of the U. States from taking part in this enterprise, and Co-operating with them. On the 6th inst. I issued a Notification Commanding all American Citizens to desist on pain of forfeiting the protection of the American Government. Copies of which I enclose for

Your better information

It is probable some thin Action will be taken in the Matter when I have heard from our Legation on the Subject and when that is the Case I will so inform You.

In Conclusion Permit me to assure you Gentlemen, that any Conduct on the part of Citizens of the U. States in China Calculated to endanger the friendship which has so long existed between the two Nations, will meet the Severest Condemnation of My Government.

I have the honor to be Very Respectfully
Your Obedient Servant
Signed J. J. Hendus Va
United States Consul
Amoy & Formosa.